

INFORMATION TO USERS

This reproduction was made from a copy of a manuscript sent to us for publication and microfilming. While the most advanced technology has been used to photograph and reproduce this manuscript, the quality of the reproduction is heavily dependent upon the quality of the material submitted. Pages in any manuscript may have indistinct print. In all cases the best available copy has been filmed.

The following explanation of techniques is provided to help clarify notations which may appear on this reproduction.

1. Manuscripts may not always be complete. When it is not possible to obtain missing pages, a note appears to indicate this.
2. When copyrighted materials are removed from the manuscript, a note appears to indicate this.
3. Oversize materials (maps, drawings, and charts) are photographed by sectioning the original, beginning at the upper left hand corner and continuing from left to right in equal sections with small overlaps. Each oversize page is also filmed as one exposure and is available, for an additional charge, as a standard 35mm slide or in black and white paper format.*
4. Most photographs reproduce acceptably on positive microfilm or microfiche but lack clarity on xerographic copies made from the microfilm. For an additional charge, all photographs are available in black and white standard 35mm slide format.*

***For more information about black and white slides or enlarged paper reproductions, please contact the Dissertations Customer Services Department.**

U·M·I Dissertation
Information Service

University Microfilms International
A Bell & Howell Information Company
300 N. Zeeb Road, Ann Arbor, Michigan 48106

PREVIEW

1328496

Harty, Michael Paul

SU SHIH'S "CHUNG YUNG LUN"

The University of Arizona

M.A. 1986

University
Microfilms
International 300 N. Zeeb Road, Ann Arbor, MI 48106

PREVIEW

PREVIEW

蘇
軾
之
中
庸
論

PREVIEW

PREVIEW

SU SHIH'S "CHUNG YUNG LUN"

by

Michael Paul Harty

A Thesis Submitted to the Faculty of the
DEPARTMENT OF ORIENTAL STUDIES
In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements
For the Degree of
MASTER OF ARTS
In the Graduate College
THE UNIVERSITY OF ARIZONA

1 9 8 6

STATEMENT BY AUTHOR

This thesis has been submitted in partial fulfillment of requirements for an advanced degree at The University of Arizona and is deposited in the University Library to be made available to borrowers under rules of the Library.

Brief quotations from this thesis are allowable without special permission, provided that accurate acknowledgment of source is made. Requests for permission for extended quotation from or reproduction of this manuscript in whole or in part may be granted by the head of the major department or the Dean of the Graduate College when in his or her judgment the proposed use of the material is in the interests of scholarship. In all other instances, however, permission must be obtained from the author.

SIGNED:

Michael R. Hardy

APPROVAL BY THESIS DIRECTOR

This thesis has been approved on the date shown below:

Robert M. Gimello

ROBERT M. GIMELLO
Professor of Oriental Studies

6/24/88
Date

TO OUR DAUGHTER HELEN

PREVIEW

PREFACE

One night six years ago I read Ezra Pound's translation of the Ta Hsueh and the Chung Yung. I had found it by chance that afternoon lying out on one of the tables of the library belonging to the community college I was going to at the time. That night began my study of Chinese language and culture, filled with the desire to read the Confucian classics in the original. Over the years I have reread the Classics, especially the Four Books, many times, gradually entering into the real texts as my Chinese progressed enough to begin seeing the wisdom of these books in their own syntax.

In many ways this thesis fulfills my objectives of six years ago. Naturally its shape now reflects my years of training at the University of Arizona. But I warn the reader that this thesis is still full of the exhilaration of a young man who read the words of K'ung Tzu, Tze Ssu and Tseng Tzu while his friends drank beer in the next room. The warmth of adolescent discovery is in this, though I am now pushing twenty-seven. This paper is as much a way for me to recapture and preserve my first impulses toward the Far East, which indeed appeared in high school, as it is a scholarly vehicle to explore the ideas of a fascinating man, who I believe shared my enthusiasm, Su Shih.

Now, Su Shih was entirely new to me until Dr. West suggested I translate his essay on the Chung Yung, my favorite of all the classics.

I must say that Su Shih and the world in which he lived has proven to be one of the most lively discoveries I have made while at University. I am guilty, as Dr. Gimello has pointed out, of investing too much of myself in Su Shih's character. While undoubtedly an unscholarly position to take, Su Shih is a hero of mine.

The first chapter of this study is an examination of the "story" of Su Shih's character. It is the sketch of a Chinese archetype, and I present him in the full psychological regalia granted him by his race. I do this consciously and in the faith that the human psyche provides for itself, through myth and story, with as great if not greater a sense of purpose than the men of history whose actions have been scribbled down by some librarian, and whose exploits we feel comfortable in calling "facts." The second chapter examines the story of the Chung Yung. The third brings the two together in Su Shih's essay. The fourth explicates that essay, though I will not say it exhausts it. The fifth is a simple farewell. The calligraphy, with the exception of the frontispiece, which is by my wife, is my own and I am solely responsible for its gawkiness.

I would like to thank Dr. Robert M. Gimello for his help throughout the time I have studied under him, for the books he gave me, and for his willingness to listen to what I have had to say. I thank also Dr. Stephen H. West for suggesting this project in the first place, and for his indispensable assistance in bringing it to sound completion. I am indeed grateful to Dr. William R. Schultz for his warm heart, generosity and fertile suggestions. I am grateful also to

Barbara Cook for typing the final copy. Most of all I thank my wife, Mary Jean Blessington, for her love, support, sense of humor and help with the typing.

With deep respect for the courage, imagination and humanity of Su Shih, I submit this small stack of paper to his memory. May his spirit gain some sustenance from it.

October, 1985

PREVIEW

TABLE OF CONTENTS

	Page
I. THE STORY OF SU SHIH'S CHARACTER	1
II. THE <u>CHUNG YUNG</u>	25
III. TRANSLATION OF THE "CHUNG YUNG LUN"	56
<u>Section one, shang</u>	56
<u>Section two, chung</u>	64
<u>Section three, hsia</u>	69
IV. SU SHIH'S "CHUNG YUNG LUN"	74
V. ENVOY	93
APPENDIX: A CHRONOLOGY OF SU SHIH	96
SELECTED BIBLIOGRAPHY	103

ABSTRACT

Su Shih's "Chung Yung Lun" analyzes the essay on the Chung Yung written by Su Shih at the time he was taking the hsien-liang exams which placed him from the start of his political career in a distinguished position. This distinction coupled with his unusually energetic and outspoken sincerity made him a particularly apt scapegoat for the reformists of his era. The main thesis states that Su Shih's personality led him to a highly creative revitalization of the basic tenets of Classical Confucianism. This revitalization is further shown to incorporate the more openly mystical veins of Confucian values found in I Ching, Chung Yung and Meng Tzu. This paper concentrates primarily on Su Shih's character, Chung Yung and Su Shih's essay. Showing both how his character affected the Classic and how the Classic affected him, in broader terms it attempts to speak of Su Shih as the embodiment of an heroic archetype in the Chinese psyche.

CHAPTER I

THE STORY OF SU SHIH'S CHARACTER

My favorite story from the life of Su Shih (蘇軾 1037-1101) is found in Lin Yutang's life of the "cultural teddy bear"¹ when he was acting as judge in Hang-chou while serving as governor from 1089 to 1091:

'My family runs a fan shop,' said the defendant. 'Last year my father died, leaving me some debts. It has rained so much this spring that people do not want to pay the debts.'

Su Tungpo paused. His eyes brightened with a good idea. He looked at the brush and ink on the table and felt fit for good exercise that morning.

'Bring me a pile of your fans and I will sell them for you,' he said to the man.

The man went home and soon brought back twenty round silk fans. Using the judge's brush on the table, Su began to write running scripts, and painted bare winter trees, bamboos, and rocks on these fans. In an hour or so he had finished painting all twenty of them. Giving these to the man, he said, 'Go out and pay your debts.'

Surprised by his luck and thanking the governor profusely, the man hugged his fans and hustled out of the court. Reports were already going around that the governor was painting fans for sale. The moment the man stepped outside the gate, he was surrounded with people who offered to pay a thousand cash for a

1. Hatch, Sung Biographies, p. 901. This is George Hatch's description of Lin Yutang's Su Shih. While easily able to see why Hatch would say this, I wholeheartedly disagree with his tone.

fan, and in a few minutes all the fans were sold, to the regret of the latecomers.²

While this story has obvious notes of the sentimental and story-book about it, it much more importantly illustrates many of the character traits which have made Su Shih a beloved figure of Chinese literature and history. His generosity, his independence of thought, the profuse and easy flow of his creativity--the diversity of that creativity, ranging through poetry, calligraphy and painting--his compassion, his delight in life, as well as his delight in finding a centered point of action rather than inflicting the punishment of the law (his least favorite duty). All of these come clear in this small story. Many of these themes, particularly delight, we will see emerge in his essay on the Chung Yung. Taking the feeling and intuitive sides of the man into account is the only way to appreciate his philosophical writings. Su Shih was first and foremost a poet. His genius had little restraint, and sprang from intensity of feeling. It runs through his commentaries and philosophical writings as well as his poetry. Continually he shows forth "the deep-felt love for his fellow men that underlies all his writing."³

To Su Shih, heart-felt devotion to right out-weighed intellectual devotion to consistency. His writings possess their own consistency based on the movements of the heart (hsin 心) and human

2. Lin, Gay Genius, pp. 302-303. A full chronology of Su Shih's life is given as an appendix to this study, pp. 96-102.

3. Yoshikawa, p. 99.

feeling (jen-ch'ing 人情), not a narrow casuistry--that banner of life's arid things which squanders the inner wealth of its subject, humanity, on the minute details of behavior. It denies the heart its voice. Su Shih never did.

He cared more about his fellow men than he did about laws, statutory or philosophical. In a famous poem written to his brother, Su Ch'e (蘇軾 1039-1112), he joked, "I will read ten thousand books, but spare me the ones on law!"⁴ He embodied the spiritual freedom of Chuang Tzu, yet upheld the Confucian virtues of official position. In the breadth of his personality he ranged over the entirety of Chinese culture, bringing into himself and pouring back into the world its paradox and diversity. Rising above the congestion of conflicting philosophical stances, he created a personality which gave to mankind in abundance, while always retaining for itself the integrity and justice which comes from knowing one's own heart, and thereby knowing the hearts of all men.⁵ While Su Shih encompassed fantastic breadth in his personality, what stands out the most clearly, and as we shall see, what got him into the most trouble, "impeached first and last for perversion of the tao,"⁶ was his utter embodiment of the Confucian virtue of "uprightness" (chih 直). "Uprightness or chih is what comes from within. It is the direct expression of one's

4. Ibid., p. 99.

5. See Analects, VI, 28.

6. Hatch, Sung Biog., p. 906.

heart."⁷ And again, "the man who is upright acts according to his own feelings, whereas the man who is crooked acts according to the feelings of others."⁸ The life of Su Shih was one practical demonstration after another of chih. He persistently memorialized the throne criticizing the reforms of the law-oriented Premier, Wang An-shih (王安石 1021-1086), and pleading for help in correcting their disastrous consequences, which he witnessed in the provinces. He publicly humiliated the Neo-Confucian philosopher, Ch'eng I (程頤 1033-1108).⁹ His satirical poetry, and some of his communications with the emperor, twice earned him exile, trumped up into veiled attacks on the emperor's dignity by the partisans of Wang An-shih, who dogged him to his life's end. All of these demonstrate his courage in standing up to the defects of his time, and the directness with which he addressed them. This was his "perversion of the tao"--the way to be virtuous and to govern men according to those in power.

Wang An-shih and Ch'eng I, indeed, were two of his great adversaries in life, the former in politics, the latter in thought and behavior. Each embodied the inflexibility of heart which Su Shih combatted. Having seen the results of such rigidity in the suffering of the people, he had no choice. It was chiefly his "unorthodox" opposition to Wang's policies that led to his exiles. This unorthodoxy lay solely in his opposition to the political winds of his

7. Fung Yu-lan, History, vol. I, p. 67.

8. Ibid., vol. I, p. 67.

9. Lin, Genius, p. 262.

time. His "perversion of the tao" was strictly a matter of the unreadiness of his contemporaries to accept his opinions.

His opinions were based in the heart and not on the political drawing board. They reflected his experiences while serving on provincial posts, not the speculations of economic wizardry. Su was by no means merely disinterested or unskilled in tackling practical problems. He brilliantly handled the administrative problems set before him from flood control to the prevention of famine.¹⁰ His beautification of Hang-chou is famous. The dikes, promenades and observation towers he constructed are still proud possessions of the city. But his gifts extended also into the regions of feeling. Not only could he hear court cases; he could render humane verdicts. In classic Confucian manner he approached each situation as a unique instance of human relatedness to the universal way (ta-tao 達道)¹¹ correlated in the flux of endless change (yi 易). Recognizing a situation as unique, he allowed himself the freedom to respond uniquely, finding the chord in his heart which sounded at the touch of human reality. The feelings being touched, the mind could respond in kind with appropriate and straightforward action. This kind of suppleness is not the lack of a standard, but on the contrary the application of a very subtle, very genuine standardless standard, that of the human heart which is unpredictable and without the kind of certainties most people look for. For Confucianism the heart was an important source of all other

10. See Ibid., pp. 301-316.

11. Doctrine of the Mean, I, 4.

standards, and the vehicle of "co-humanity" (jen 仁). It has long fascinated me that the ancient Chinese joined the concepts of heart and mind together in one word: hsin 心. I find it no less fascinating that with the development of the language the word ch'ing 情 has come to mean both "feeling" and also "fact, detail, situation,"¹² in other words, the facts of a case such as might come before a court of law. The "facts" are the "feelings" involved. Thus Su Shih wrote in his commentary on the Book of Changes, (I Ching 易經): "Those good at handling the world do not seek certainties (pi-jan 必然); seeking certainties will bring affairs to a total loss."¹³ "Certainties" are the source of the inflexible denial of the heart engendering human misery, in the enforcement of law and the practice of ritual.¹⁴ Flexibility is the responsibility of one who wants to be deliberate in his relationship to the nature of change spoken of in the Book of Changes. The humane approach to affairs for which Su Shih suffered was that of flexibility.

Ch'eng I was a seeker after certainties. Lin Yutang relates the story of the former Prime Minister and historian, Ssu-ma Kuang's funeral rites in 1086, over which Ch'eng I, the "ultra-puritanical

12. A New Practical Chinese-English Dictionary, p. 330. Liang Shih-chiu, ed. in chief. Far East Book Co., Ltd. See also Graham's article, "The Background of the Mencian Theory of Human Nature," p. 258 ff., which discusses the origins and development of ch'ing in far greater detail.

13. Chapt. 3, p. 60; see Sung Bibliography, p. 6.

14. See Tu's article, "The Creative Tension Between Jen and Li."

neo-Confucianist,"¹⁵ was presiding. Because the day of the mourning rite happened to coincide with the day that the spirit tablet of the emperor Shen-tsung (神宗 r.1068-1086) was installed in the Sung ancestral temple, Ch'eng I insisted that none of the members of court, all of whom Su Shih had led over to pay their respects to the dead Prime Minister, could properly participate in the rite. One stuffy injunction led to another and the entire incident culminated in Su Shih publicly humiliating Ch'eng I, saying: "That is the ceremony of a dumpy, dowdy schoolmaster."¹⁶ The insufferable casuistry of Ch'eng I was more than Su Shih could tolerate, for in light of the unusual circumstances, Ch'eng I's insistence on adherence to ritual (li 禮), was wholly inappropriate, running counter to the "facts" as well as the "feelings" involved. Again in his commentary on the Changes, Su says this: "whatever hits the appropriate time is righteous and workable."¹⁷ One acts according to the circumstances, not in obedience to an inflexible standard which takes no account of the unique aspects of a situation.

I have used Wang An-shih and Ch'eng I as models of inflexibility against which to demonstrate Su Shih's tenacity in following his own heart. At the risk of burdening my readers with a rather circuitous approach to the life of a profound and fascinating man, I am attempting to demonstrate the values by which that man lived, insisting that as expressions of his character they form a coherent

15. Lin, Genius, p. 262; for entire incident see pp. 261-263.

16. Ibid., p. 263.

17. Hatch, Sung Bib., p. 6.

whole. To merely outline the facts of his life--the offices he held, the poems he wrote, the periods of exile for his uprightness in both--would be of no immediate use to my study which is more concerned with the man's feeling and intuitive approach to Confucian concepts. I should mention too, that I am in contention with Dr. Hatch, who while providing invaluable source material on Su Shih, and recognizing the internal coherence of his philosophical views,¹⁸ nonetheless, I feel, projects his own skepticism onto Su Shih, especially in metaphysical and supernatural matters. He also echoes, though in less felicitous terms, the statement of Yoshikawa Kojiro in, An Introduction to Sung Poetry: "The principal fault of Su Tung-p'o's poetry is that he often wrote with an ease and facility that bordered on carelessness."¹⁹ "Carelessness" is not right at all. Su Shih described his own writing as follows:

My writings are like the waters of an inexhaustible spring which spread out everywhere over the land. Along the level ground they surge and billow, flowing with ease a thousand li in a single day. And when they encounter hills and boulders, bends and turns, they take form from the things about them, though I do not know how they do it. All I know is that they always go where they should go, and stop where they should stop, that is all. Beyond that, even I do not understand.²⁰

Here is the heart-felt devotion to right out-weighing the intellectual devotion to consistency. Bluntly, I feel it is a mistake for the critic to suppose that he can understand what the poet himself cannot about his

18. See Hatch, Sung Bib., p. 6, paragraph 3; p. 15, para. 1.

19. Yoshikawa, p. 120. Tung-p'o (東坡) is Su Shih's best known literary name (hao 號). It means "eastern slope," which is explained in the Appendix.

20. Ibid., p. 102.

own creation.²¹ The dismissal as "carelessness" bothers me, as well as Hatch's accusation of Su Shih's 'sloppy pi-chi habits."²² While appreciating the scholar's frustrations in collection and attribution, I feel this is a prime example of Dr. Hatch's projection on Su Shih. For my part I find Su Shih's "habits" refreshing. Rather than "careless," I find them pleasing in their disregard (and even their inapplicability) for fastidious scholarship. Undoubtedly out of the 2400 extant poems of Su Shih, there are times when the poet falls short. But falling short cannot properly be called "carelessness."

It reminds me of the story of Picasso and the art dealer. An art dealer had found a painting in some small rummage shop that he was certain, from the style, was a genuine, though unknown, Picasso. The dealer bought the painting at a very low price, and then took off to see the master himself, and confirm that it was indeed from his hand. When Picasso saw the painting he said immediately, "It's a fake." The dealer was aghast, certain that Picasso had painted it, and argued with him, pointing out that he was an expert, and was certain by the style that Picasso had painted it. Without again looking up at the man, the painter answered, "Yes, I often paint fakes."²³

21. For an explanation I feel does get at the question in terms far superior to "carelessness," see Carl Jung's essay, "The Relation of Analytical Psychology to Poetry," especially on the "extroverted type" of artist. Portable Jung, pp. 301-322.

22. Hatch, Sung Bib., p. 332, see also p. 396.

23. I read this story several years ago, and unfortunately, I cannot remember where.

The point of the story is that while the creative on-rush is genuine, the artist may not always respond genuinely. He may try to fake it for the sake of feeling productive. Further, the art dealer, like the critic, is often keen enough to pick out the marks of a particular artist's touch, just as ballistics can tell what gun a bullet has been fired from by the grooving in the lead. However, knowing that alone is not the same as having the discernment to tell whether or not the bullet struck its mark.²⁴ It is like the discernment of Chung Yung, Chapt. IV: "There are no men who do not eat and drink; few are able to know the flavors." We do not know whether or not Su Shih wrote any poems he considered "fakes." But we do know, from the statement quoted above, that he felt that his writing did everything it "should." The sloppiness of his pi-chi habits and the carelessness of his poems are totally relative to the value one puts on a particular detail to the exclusion of a hundred others.

Likewise, when Dr. Hatch concedes the internal consistency of Su Shih's thought on the classics (I am thinking particularly of his articles on the Su Shih I-chuan, 蘇軾易傳, and the Tung-p'o Shu-chuan, 東坡書傳),²⁵ I agree with him only to the point of his assessment of the value of the writings:

There lies the interest of the work, however: we want to know not what the Shu-ching really says, but what the commentator

24. Cf. Su Shih's lines: "A new poem is like a cross bow pellet; Once it's left the hand it never stops a moment." Yoshikawa, p. 120. Compare the entire problem to Doctrine of the Mean, IV, 2; see Chapt. III, note 55 of this study.

25. Hatch, Sung Bib., pp. 4-9, 13-19 respectively.